

Profile

Personal Information

Name Omukaga, Joan *Nekoye*
Preferred Name Nekoye
Sex, Birthdate Female, 05/04/2002

Contact Details

Email, Phone joannekoye@gmail.com, +254.720241175, Mobile, +254.722465381, Home
Permanent Address 8th Floor, Equity Centre - Upperhill P.O Box 75104 Nairobi, Nairobi, 00200, KEN

Demographics

Military Status None
Hispanic or Latino No
Race Black or African American (Africa)

Language

English Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Other, Luyha Speak, Spoken at Home

Geography & Citizenship

Citizenship Status Other (Non-US)
Birthplace Nairobi, Kenya (0 Years US, 17 Years Non-US)
Other Citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa F-1 Student

CA Fee Waiver

Fee Waiver Requested Yes, Signed: JOAN NEKOYE OMUKAGA
I can provide a supporting statement from a school official, college access counselor, financial aid officer, or community leader

Family

Household

Parents Never Married
Home Parent 1

Parent 1

Mother

Name Ms. Catherine S. Murambi
Birthplace Kenya
Email, Phone katemurambi@gmail.com, +254.722465381, Mobile
Address the same as my home address
Occupation Other, Analyst (Chemistry), Employed, N/A, Civil Service
Education Graduated from college/university
Bachelors (1998), **Kenyatta University, Nairobi, Nairobi, KEN**

Parent 2

Limited information about this parent

Name Daniel Omukaga

Siblings

1. Laurene A. Omukaga, Age 22, Sister, Graduated from college/university, Bachelors, (09/2015 - 05/2019), **Minerva Schools at KGI, San Francisco, CA, USA**

Education

Current or Most Recent Secondary School

Booker Academy, Private Bag, Mumias, Kakamega, Western, KEN, Public (02/2015 - 11/2018)

Counselor Ms. Florence A Aseka, Career Counsellor and School Chaplain
Email, Phone floaseka@yahoo.com, +254.0728376097
Boarding School Yes: Living at School
Progression Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date 11/2018

Colleges & Universities

Grades

Rank 1 / 140, Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

First Trimester	Second Trimester	Third Trimester
Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)	Mathematics - (REG)
English - (REG)	English - (REG)	English - (REG)
Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)	Kiswahili - (REG)
History - (REG)	History - (REG)	History - (REG)
Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)	Biology - (REG)
Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)	Chemistry - (REG)
Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)	Physics - (REG)
Music - (REG)	Music - (REG)	Music - (REG)

Honors

Best student in the county & region, top 100 out of 631,750 candidates in KCSE national exam	School, State/Regional, National	12
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Gubernatorial recognition as first student in the region in all final year exams.	School, State/Regional, National	11, 12
First place, National Alliance Mathematics contest	School, State/Regional, National	11
Best overall student, Principal's Award winner in Annual Prize Giving Day	School	12
Teacher's Choice - Student with the Most Positive Influence and Impact, Annual PGD	School	11, 12

Community-Based Organizations

CBO 1	Equity Leadership Program
Counselor	Ms. Eva Muriuki
Email, Phone	eva.muriuki@equitybank.co.ke, +254.763026061
CBO 2	AKAD Education Group Africa

Future Plans

Undecided, Doctorate

Testing

SAT (March 2016 or after)

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	700	10/05/2019
Math	790	10/05/2019
Essay	15	10/05/2019
Taken	2	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	Yes	

SAT Subject Tests

Math Level 1	11/2019
Math Level 2	11/2019
Physics	11/2019

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
English	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Kiswahili	B	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
History	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Chemistry	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Biology	A-	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Physics	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE
Music	A	11/2018, Actual, KCSE

Activities

Music: Vocal

9, 10, 11, 12	Chair-lady(2017-'18), School Choir
School	Performed at school functions and festivals; emerged best secondary school in National Festivals; Performed at Presidential gala.
18 hr/wk, 18 wk/yr	
Continue	

Science/Math

11, 12	Co-chair , Mathematics Society
School	Organized extra math tuition in all classes; Best student in Alliance Contest(2017); Best(2017)and Second Runner-up school(2018)in National Contest.
7 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	
Continue	

Music: Instrumental

10, 11, 12, PG	Violinist and Cellist - Solo and String ensemble
Year	1st runner up violin solo at National Music Festival, string accompaniment during school Sunday services, Performances during school shows and events
7 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr	
Continue	

Academic

11, 12	Vice-Chair, Academic society
School	As head of literature and math committees I organised meetings, school contests; Recruited excelling students to represent the school during contests.
4 hr/wk, 34 wk/yr	
Continue	

Social Justice

PG	Activist and Mentor, AKAD Education Group Africa
Year	I raise awareness among my mentees & engage my peers in nationally neglected conversations about Mental Health, LGBTQ rights and environmentalism.
8 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

9, 10, 11	Corporal Cadet, St. John Ambulance Movement
Year	Most propitious cadet(2015), Best cadet in drills and first aid(2016); Offered first aid at school clinic, trained students on first aid.
5 hr/wk, 50 wk/yr	
Continue	

Career Oriented

9, 10, 11, 12, PG	Brand Ambassador and Member, WomEng Fellowship
Break, Year	Raising awareness for female students to pursue STEM careers
6 hr/wk, 8 wk/yr	#1MillionGirlsInSTEM; recruiting members from high schools to promote the movement.
Continue	

Internship

PG	Equity Bank Customer Relations officer
Year	In charge of inquiries desk, social media accounts and emailed service requests
61 hr/wk, 24 wk/yr	, mentored Wings to Fly scholars.
Continue	

Religious

PG	Christ Is The Answer Ministries, P/w member
Year	Singer and violinist during praise and worship; Organised children's music presentations, skits and plays
6 hr/wk, 40 wk/yr	
Continue	

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG	Teaching Assistant, PACE International
School	Volunteer teacher at Karen 'C' Primary school, from January to late February
20 hr/wk, 7 wk/yr	
Continue	

Writing

Personal Essay

Discuss an accomplishment, event, or realization that sparked a period of personal growth and a new understanding of yourself or others.

"You may trod me in the very dirt

But still, like dust, I'll rise

Just like moons and like suns,

With the certainty of tides

Still I rise

Out of the huts of history's shame

I rise" - Maya Angelou, Still I Rise.

I was calmly seated by the fire, at *kukhu's* feet. Between the crackling of the flame and crickets chirping in the distance, it was a peaceful evening in our village homestead. Out of the blue, *kukhu* began speaking in an endless string of the local tongue. I could tell she was addressing me but I hadn't a clue as to what she was saying. I wasn't conversant in the local language (*Luyha*) back then.

She noticed my blank expression and attempted to piece together a few Swahili words for me to understand. "You know, my child," she sighed. "People are often blind to the good things bestowed upon them. For instance, I never quite liked that grey cow of mine because of its ugly color but who knew it would come to be my most prized possession in producing milk?" she laughed. I wasn't sure why she was telling me this, so I smiled politely in response. Silence ensued before she continued, "To your father, you are that grey cow because you are not the son he always wanted..."

My mother came in and interrupted, "That's nothing to be telling her at her age." Despite being cut short, *kukhu* knew she had said enough, however vague the message was at the time.

My community is one that's organized along patriarchal lines. One that did not frown upon my father walking out on us when I was six years old. One that had perhaps molded his mind into thinking that, as I now knew, the 'inferior' gender of his children was a justifiable reason to do so. The immediate result was a chaotic stage in my life, fuelled by a sense of inadequacy. Not because I would grow up without a father, but because I felt the need to compensate for a part of my anatomy, or lack thereof. This manifested itself through a misplaced motivation to outrun every boy during Physical Education, climb the tallest trees, or be the best in some other dangerous 'unladylike' activity. My mother found this episode amusing.

Unexpectedly, I took a liking to poetry. Particularly, Maya Angelou's work. I admired how her poems and stories encouraged her audience to thrive against the odds because I too, in a different context, aspired to do the same. This triggered an epiphanic phase in my life where I realized that I had ignorantly declared sex the SI unit for accomplishment, thus succumbing to the typical African mindset.

At that moment, *kukhu's* words made sense. Just like her grey cow, I too could be invaluable once I found my niche. From subtly breaking gender stereotypes (I am proud to have been the first female student in 2 decades to take first place in the region in our final high school exams), to questioning the typicalities that exist within the make-up of my community, I desired to analyze the mind of society. I fell in love with social justice.

Consequently, I let go of the idea that I had to level up to my male counterparts and instead set out to become my own competition. From bigger achievements such as taking the initiative to begin a social awareness movement to smaller wins such as successfully self-teaching how to play the violin, I found myself effortlessly thriving in my element.

I recall running to *kukhu's* hut to break the news the first time I was featured in the local newspaper for stellar academic performance. Now fully capable of communicating in the vernacular, I translated the article to her and watched as her eyes gleamed with pride.

'Out of the huts of history's shame

I rise'

**kukhu - grandmother*

PREVIEW

Education Progression

Education progression details

Did or will take gap year

Required Explanation

Education progression

In January, at the beginning of my gap year, I volunteered at Karen 'C' Primary school as a teaching assistant with Pacemaker International. 7 o'clock would find me ready to interact with the children, do various projects with them and teach them a few math and science classes.

I interned at Equity Bank for six months, beginning late February, as a Customer Relations Officer, offering financial assistance and advice to customers. This was a very rigorous time but I never had dull moments because my-coworkers and I had fun times and happy customers brightened my days.

On the weekends in between, I went to high schools to mentor students and serve as a peer counselor. I engaged the students in topics such as mental health since this had become a subject I was passionate about. I also took this time to raise environmental awareness by engaging the schools in tree-planting and environment clean-up activities.

I explored my artistic side by learning to write poetry and abstract literature. I get my inspiration from the Kenya National Theater where I go to interact with content creators and support local talent. In my free time, I read a lot of books, my best being 'We're Going to Need More Wine' by Gabrielle Union.

I learned how to code in C++ and Python and also got back in touch with my musical side by playing the violin and exploring contemporary music.

Disciplinary Information

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?

No

Brown University Questions

General

Start Term	Fall 2020
Admission plan	Early Decision
Financial aid	Yes
Early Decision Agreement	Yes, I have read and understand my rights and responsibilities under the Early Decision Process. I wish to be considered as an Early Decision candidate at Brown University. I also understand that with an Early Decision offer of admissions, this institution may share my name and my early commitment with other institutions. JOAN NEKOYE OMUKAGA
Previous Candidate	No
School Specific Fee Waivers	Brown Specific Fee Waiver
Security Question	What non-social media website do you visit most frequently?
Security Answer	Bikozulu
Video Portfolio or Alumni Interview	Alumni Interview

Academics

First Concen	Psychology
Second Concen	Computer Science
PLME or Brown-RISD	Neither

Activities

Please briefly elaborate on one of your extracurricular activities or work experiences.

Among the pages of my 'Americanah' lie my flashcards, scribbled with what I hope to be inspirational material. The time is 6.30 am as I head to the Sarova Hotel. The half-hour walk across the city helps me keep my nerves in check. On arrival, I begin preparing for my speech - I was the teen representative at the annual National Gender and Equality Commission meeting.

My audience consists of government officials, social workers, and a few of my peers. The task is daunting and I feel underqualified. My worry, however, shifts into positivity as I recall the long hours spent setting up presentations on mental health and social wellness with my colleagues and the fun times we shared after running successful seminars. I trust that these smaller milestones have prepared me for this moment. I advance to the stage, confident that I'll have a wonderful and memorable experience.

Contacts

Previously applied	No
Contact	Brown's website or social media

Consent for text contact I consent to be contacted by Brown University at the mobile phone number provided below.

Mobile Phone Number: +254.0720241175

More Information

Are you in the process of applying for an ROTC Scholarship? No

ROTC at Brown No

Arts Supplement No

Are any of your siblings also applying to Brown University this year? No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.